Organizational AI Use Policy Starter

AI Literacy for the Modern Workforce

This is a conversation starter, not a policy. 69% of professionals mention the social stigma that comes with using AI at work, and many conceal their use from colleagues. This scaffold helps you initiate a conversation about shared AI use norms. You are proposing shared standards, not asking for permission. The shape is deliberate. When MIT set institution-wide AI policy in 2026, its committee rejected a single rule as too permissive for some units and too restrictive for others. It recommended instead a shared framework: a policy menu, disclosure expectations, and accountability standards that each department adapts (MIT Ad Hoc Committee, 2026, p. 7). The four areas below are that framework at team scale.

HOW TO USE

1. Review the four areas below. **2.** Draft your “Your input” answers. **3.** Bring to a 1:1 or team meeting.
4. Use as conversation structure, not a form.

1. DELEGATION NORMS

What tasks are appropriate for AI use on this team?

TOPIC	DISCUSSION PROMPT
Appropriate tasks	Which types benefit from AI? (drafting, summarizing, calculation checks, translation, data compilation, brainstorming, formatting…)
Off-limits tasks	Where should AI not be used? (client-confidential, regulatory, personnel decisions, work that turns on empathy or in-person judgment…)
Data boundaries	What info can/cannot be shared with AI tools? (proprietary, client, internal strategy…)
Tool selection	Which AI tools are approved or preferred?

Expect disagreement at the boundary. In MIT's 2026 community survey, most respondents accepted AI for spelling and grammar, research, and code. Most rejected it for peer review or drafting paragraphs from notes. The committee found that people disagree on what 'support' means, so it recommends naming allowed uses explicitly (MIT Ad Hoc Committee, 2026, pp. 30, 33).

YOUR INPUT

I currently use AI for ___. I avoid it for ___. I’d like clarity on ___.

2. DISCLOSURE NORMS

What transparency is expected?

TOPIC	DISCUSSION PROMPT
Internal work	What disclosure for internal deliverables? (None? Verbal? Written?)
Client-facing	What disclosure for external or client-facing deliverables?
Threshold	Stakes level below which disclosure isn’t necessary?
Format	Diligence statement, footnote, verbal note, or team documentation? (Precedent: MIT's 2026 policy requires every thesis to state how AI was used and bars AI as a co-author. It asks anyone presenting AI-generated content or using AI in evaluation to disclose how and why. MIT Ad Hoc Committee, 2026, pp. 20, 22.)

YOUR INPUT

I currently disclose by ___. I'm unsure about disclosure for ___.

3. VERIFICATION NORMS

What review standard applies?

TOPIC	DISCUSSION PROMPT
Minimum standard	What verification before sharing? (spot-check? full review? peer review?)
High-stakes work	Deliverable types needing extra verification? (client-facing, financial, legal)
Accountability	Who's accountable for errors — delegator, reviewer, or both? Some workers skip verification because they see it as someone else's job (11 of 319 in one survey), and some because a quota leaves no time (44 of 319). A norm has to answer both. Source: Lee et al., CHI 2025, p. 11.
Escalation	If an error reaches a client or stakeholder, how is that handled?

YOUR INPUT

I currently verify by ___. I'd like agreement on the standard for ___.

4. DOCUMENTATION NORMS

How is AI use recorded on this team?

TOPIC	DISCUSSION PROMPT
Team visibility	Track at individual, project, or team level?
Learning sharing	How do members share effective practices? (channel, retros, docs) Framing verification as skill-building rather than a per-task audit is the framing researchers recommend for keeping it alive (Lee et al., CHI 2025, p. 15).
Improvement	How to evaluate whether AI improves quality, not just speed? (Organizations reporting significant AI returns are twice as likely to have a defined process for this.)

YOUR INPUT

I'd find it helpful if our team ___ to share what's working.

STARTING THE CONVERSATION

If raising AI norms feels uncomfortable, that's the concealment dynamic. Three framing options:

Frame 1: Process improvement

"I've been thinking about how we could be more consistent in how we use AI tools. I put together some discussion points — could we spend 10 minutes in our next 1:1?"

Frame 2: Quality standard

"I want to make sure my AI-assisted work meets the team's standards. Can we align on what verification and disclosure look like for our deliverables?"

Frame 3: Team learning

"I think several of us are using AI but figuring it out independently. Would it be useful to agree on shared practices so we can learn from each other?"

The goal is to replace private, uncoordinated AI use with visible, accountable team practice, not to create bureaucracy. Attach a reason to each norm. MIT's 2026 policy review found that rules stated without a rationale confused people and that policing unauthorized use damaged working relationships. It recommends that every AI policy explain why use is required, permitted, or restricted (MIT Ad Hoc Committee, 2026, pp. 5, 16–17).

Framework: 4D AI Fluency Framework, Diligence competency, Transparency sub-component (Dakan & Feller, 2025, p. 6), as taught in Anthropic's AI Fluency course. Impact-measurement figure: McKinsey, The state of AI in 2026, p. 19. Task examples: WEF Future of Jobs Report 2025, Box 3.1, p. 44.

© Michael Ritchot. Code licensed under the MIT License. Instructional content licensed under CC BY-NC-SA 4.0.